Measurement conversions

QUICK REFERENCE | Suggested grades 3-6 | Math

Use matching units. These customary measures use U.S. units.

Length

U.S. customary	Metric
12 inches = 1 foot	10 millimeters = 1 centimeter
3 feet = 1 yard	100 centimeters = 1 meter
5,280 feet = 1 mile	1,000 meters = 1 kilometer

Capacity and mass / weight

U.S. liquid capacity	Metric capacity
8 fluid ounces = 1 cup	1,000 milliliters = 1 liter
2 cups = 1 pint	Metric mass
2 pints = 1 quart	1,000 milligrams = 1 gram
4 quarts = 1 gallon	1,000 grams = 1 kilogram

U.S. customary weight

16 ounces = 1 pound. 2,000 pounds = 1 short ton.

Choose multiply or divide

Larger unit to smaller unit: multiply. 3 feet x 12 = 36 inches.

Smaller unit to larger unit: divide. 200 centimeters divided by 100 = 2 meters.

Check the label

A fluid ounce measures volume. An ounce of weight measures weight. They are not the same kind of measurement.